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Annular dome assembly for a combustor

Abstract

An annular dome assembly for a combustor. The annular dome assembly includes an annular dome including one or more dome panels defining the annular dome. A first dome panel includes a dome upstream surface and a dome downstream surface opposite the dome upstream surface. One or more dome arms extend from the dome upstream surface. One or more apertures extend from the dome upstream surface to the dome downstream surface. The annular dome assembly also includes a deflector assembly including one or more deflector panels defining the deflector assembly. A first deflector panel includes a deflector upstream surface and a deflector downstream surface opposite the deflector upstream surface. One or more deflector arms extend from the deflector upstream surface. Each of the one or more deflector arms are mounted within a respective aperture of the annular dome.

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Background/Summary

CROSS REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) The present application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/811,762 filed on Jul. 11, 2022, which claims the benefit of Indian patent application Ser. No. 20/221.1019498, filed on Mar. 31, 2022, the entire contents of which are hereby incorporated by reference in their entireties.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) The present disclosure relates to an annular dome assembly for a combustor of a gas turbine engine, and, more particularly, to an improved mounting arrangement for an annular dome assembly.

BACKGROUND

(2) A gas turbine engine may include a combustion section having a combustor that generates hot combustion gases discharged into a turbine section of the engine. The combustion section may include an annular dome assembly including an annular dome and a deflector assembly to shield portions of the combustion section from the hot combustion gases. The deflector assembly may be mounted to the annular dome.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) Features and advantages of the present disclosure will be apparent from the following description of various exemplary embodiments, as illustrated in the accompanying drawings, wherein like reference numbers generally indicate identical, functionally similar, and/or structurally similar elements.
- (2) FIG. 1A is a schematic cross-sectional diagram of a turbine engine, taken along a centerline axis of the turbine engine, according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.
- (3) FIG. 1B is a schematic partial cross-sectional view of a portion of an exemplary combustion section used in a turbine engine and having an exemplary annular dome assembly, according to an aspect of the present disclosure.
- (4) FIG. 2A is a schematic partial cross-sectional view, taken at detail 2A in FIG. 1B, of a portion of an annular dome assembly of the combustion section, according to an aspect of the present disclosure.
- (5) FIG. 2B is an enlarged view of a portion of the annular dome assembly as indicated by a detail 2B in FIG. 2A, according to an aspect of the present disclosure.
- (6) FIG. 3A is a cross-sectional front view, taken at line 3-3 in FIG. 2A, of a first example of an arm of the annular dome assembly, according to an aspect of the present disclosure.
- (7) FIG. 3B is a cross-sectional front view of a second example of an arm of the annular dome assembly, according to an aspect of the present disclosure.
- (8) FIG. 4A is a schematic partial cross-sectional view of another annular dome assembly, according to aspects of the present disclosure.
- (9) FIG. 4B is a schematic partial cross-sectional view of another annular dome assembly, according to aspects of the present disclosure.
- (10) FIG. 4C is a schematic partial cross-sectional view of another annular dome assembly, according to aspects of the present disclosure.
- (11) FIG. 4D is a schematic partial cross-sectional view of another annular dome assembly, according to aspects of the present disclosure.
- (12) FIG. 5A is a front view of an upstream surface of a portion of a deflector assembly for the annular dome assembly of FIG. 1B, according to aspects of the present disclosure.
- (13) FIG. 5B is a front view of an upstream surface of a portion of the annular dome assembly of FIG. 1B, according to aspects of the present disclosure.
- (14) FIG. 5C is a front view of an upstream surface of a portion of another deflector assembly for the annular dome assembly of FIG. 1B, according to aspects of the present disclosure.
- (15) FIG. 5D is a front view of an upstream surface of a portion of another annular dome assembly, according to aspects of the present disclosure.
- (16) FIG. 6A is a front view of an upstream surface of a portion of another deflector assembly for the annular dome assembly of FIG. 1B, according to aspects of the present disclosure.
- (17) FIG. 6B is a front view of an upstream surface of a portion of another annular dome assembly, according to aspects of the present disclosure.
- (18) FIG. 7A is a front view of an upstream surface of a portion of another deflector assembly for

the annular dome assembly, according to aspects of the present disclosure.

(19) FIG. 7B is a front view of an upstream surface of a portion of another annular dome assembly, according to aspects of the present disclosure.

(20) FIG. 8A is a front view of a downstream surface of another deflector assembly for the annular dome assembly, according to aspects of the present disclosure.

(21) FIG. 8B is a front view of a downstream surface of another deflector assembly for the annular dome assembly, according to aspects of the present disclosure.

(22) FIG. 8C is a front view of a downstream surface of another deflector assembly for the annular dome assembly, according to aspects of the present disclosure.

(23) FIG. 8D is a front view of a downstream surface of another deflector assembly for the annular dome assembly, according to aspects of the present disclosure.

(24) FIG. 9A is an enlarged view of one or more gaps of the deflector assembly of FIG. 4A, according to aspects of the present disclosure.

(25) FIG. 9B is an enlarged view of another embodiment of the one or more gaps, according to aspects of the present disclosure.

(26) FIG. 9C is an enlarged view of another embodiment of the one or more gaps, according to aspects of the present disclosure.

(27) FIG. 9D is an enlarged view of another embodiment of the one or more gaps, according to aspects of the present disclosure.

(28) FIG. 10A is a schematic partial cross-sectional view of a portion of another annular dome assembly of the combustion section, according to aspects of the present disclosure.

(29) FIG. 10B is an enlarged cross-sectional view, taken at detail 10B in FIG. 10A, of the annular dome assembly and the deflector assembly.

(30) FIG. 10C is an enlarged cross-sectional view of another embodiment of the annular dome assembly and the deflector assembly.

(31) FIG. 11A is a schematic partial cross-sectional view of a portion of another annular dome assembly, according to aspects of the present disclosure.

(32) FIG. 11B is an enlarged cross-sectional view, taken at detail 11B in FIG. 11A, of the annular dome assembly and the deflector assembly.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(33) Features, advantages, and embodiments of the present disclosure are set forth or apparent from a consideration of the following detailed description, drawings, and claims. Moreover, it is to be understood that the following detailed description is exemplary and intended to provide further explanation without limiting the scope of the disclosure as claimed.

(34) Various embodiments are discussed in detail below. While specific embodiments are discussed, this is done for illustration purposes only. A person skilled in the relevant art will recognize that other components and configurations may be used without departing from the spirit and the scope of the present disclosure.

(35) As used herein, the terms “first,” “second,” and “third” may be used interchangeably to distinguish one component from another and are not intended to signify location or importance of the individual components.

(36) The terms “upstream” and “downstream” refer to the relative direction with respect to fluid flow in a fluid pathway. For example, “upstream” refers to the direction from which the fluid flows, and “downstream” refers to the direction to which the fluid flows.

(37) The terms “coupled,” “fixed,” “attached,” “connected,” and the like, refer to both direct coupling, fixing, attaching, or connecting, as well as indirect coupling, fixing, attaching, or connecting through one or more intermediate components or features, unless otherwise specified herein.

(38) The singular forms “a,” “an,” and “the” include plural references unless the context clearly dictates otherwise.

(39) Approximating language, as used herein throughout the specification and claims, is applied to modify any quantitative representation that could permissibly vary without resulting in a change in the basic function to which it is related. Accordingly, a value modified by a term or terms, such as “about,” “approximately,” “generally,” and “substantially” is not to be limited to the precise value specified. In at least some instances, the approximating language may correspond to the precision of an instrument for measuring the value, or the precision of the methods or the machines for constructing the components and/or the systems or manufacturing the components and/or the systems. For example, the approximating language may refer to being within a one, two, four, ten, fifteen, or twenty percent margin in either individual values, range(s) of values and/or endpoints defining range(s) of values.

(40) In combustors without the benefit of the present disclosure, a bolted arrangement of one or more bolts may be used to fasten the deflector assembly to the annular dome. The bolted arrangement typically includes a bolt at each of the corners of panels of the deflector assembly. When the deflector assembly and the annular dome are assembled, a head portion of the bolts may be exposed to hot combustion gases. Accordingly, the bolted arrangement of some deflector assemblies may experience thermal distress around the bolts due to the proximity of the head portions to the hot combustion gases. In some instances, the thermal distress around the bolts may cause failure to a portion of the deflector assembly around a bolt region or damage a portion of the deflector assembly around a bolt region. Thus, embodiments of the present disclosure provide for an improved mounting arrangement of the deflector assembly such that the bolts (or other fastening mechanisms) are disposed entirely on a cold side of the deflector assembly. In this way, the fastening mechanisms (e.g., bolts, brazing, rivets, etc.) may be disposed in a low thermal gradient zone, rather than a high thermal gradient zone. Such an arrangement may help to improve a durability and a life cycle of such deflector assemblies as compared to deflector assemblies without the benefit of the present disclosure.

(41) The deflector assembly of the present disclosure may include extended fins or arms that are extended into a corresponding sectoral slot, or aperture, of the annular dome. For example, the fins or the arms of the deflector assembly may be inserted into the respective sectoral slots, or apertures, of the annular dome. In this way, the deflector assembly may be mounted to the annular dome. The fins or the arms may be bolted, brazed, and/or riveted to secure the fins or the arms to the annular dome. The fins or the arms may be spaced circumferentially around a respective panel. In some instances, air may leak through an area of a bolt. Thus, the fins or the arms may be brazed to respective arms of the annular dome to help to reduce leakage of air or to prevent leakage of air. A gap between the deflector assembly and the annular dome may be controlled using an outer rim of the deflector assembly that may be seated on the annular dome. One or more seals may be used to seal the gap in addition to, or alternatively to, the outer rim.

(42) The deflector assembly may include one or more panels that together define the deflector assembly. Each panel may include a singular, unitary piece. In some examples, each panel may be segmented such that each panel includes a plurality of separate segments. Each segment may include one or more of the fins or one or more of the arms such that each segment may be separately attached to the annular dome and/or separately removed from the annular dome. This may allow for ease of maintenance such that only segments that are worn or are otherwise damaged may be removed and replaced, rather than removing and replacing an entire panel of the deflector assembly.

(43) A portion of cooling air may be directed to a downstream surface (e.g., a hot side) of the deflector assembly through one or more gaps between respective segments of a panel. The one or more gaps between the segments may include various size, shapes, and/or angles to direct the cooling air, as desired. Further, cooling air may also be directed to a corner formed between the fins or the arms and a respective panel to further increase a durability of the panel in an area of the fins or the arms. The corner formed between the fins or the arms and the respective panel may include a

blended corner such that the surface of the fins or the arms smoothly blends into the surface of the respective panel. This may help to reduce stress on the corner.

(44) Referring now to the drawings, FIG. 1A is a schematic cross-sectional diagram of a turbine engine **10**, taken along a centerline axis of the turbine engine **10**, according to an embodiment of the present disclosure. As shown in FIG. 1A, the turbine engine **10** defines an axial direction A (extending parallel to a longitudinal centerline **12** provided for reference) and a radial direction R that is normal to the axial direction A. In general, the turbine engine **10** includes a fan section **14** and a core turbine engine **16** disposed downstream from the fan section **14**.

(45) The core turbine engine **16** depicted generally includes an outer casing **18** that is substantially tubular and defines an annular inlet **20**. As schematically shown in FIG. 1A, the outer casing **18** encases, in serial flow relationship, a compressor section including a booster or a low pressure (LP) compressor **22** followed downstream by a high pressure (HP) compressor **24**, a combustion section **26**, a turbine section including a high pressure (HP) turbine **28** followed downstream by a low pressure (LP) turbine **30**, and a jet exhaust nozzle section **32**. A high pressure (HP) shaft **34** or spool drivingly connects the HP turbine **28** to the HP compressor **24** to rotate the HP turbine **28** and the HP compressor in unison. A low pressure (LP) shaft **36** drivingly connects the LP turbine **30** to the LP compressor **22** to rotate the LP turbine **30** and the LP compressor **22** in unison. The compressor section, the combustion section **26**, the turbine section, and the jet exhaust nozzle section **32** together define a core air flowpath.

(46) For the embodiment depicted in FIG. 1A, the fan section **14** includes a fan **38** (e.g., a variable pitch fan) having a plurality of fan blades **40** coupled to a disk **42** in a spaced apart manner. As depicted in FIG. 1A, the fan blades **40** extend outwardly from the disk **42** generally along the radial direction R. Each fan blade **40** is rotatable relative to the disk **42** about a pitch axis P by virtue of the fan blades **40** being operatively coupled to an actuation member **44** configured to collectively vary the pitch of the fan blades **40** in unison. The fan blades **40**, the disk **42**, and the actuation member **44** are together rotatable about the longitudinal centerline **12** via a fan shaft **45** that is powered by the LP shaft **36** across a power gearbox **46**, also referred to as a gearbox assembly **46**. The gearbox assembly **46** includes a plurality of gears for adjusting the rotational speed of the fan shaft **45** and, thus, the fan **38** relative to the LP shaft **36** to a more efficient rotational fan speed.

(47) Referring still to the exemplary embodiment of FIG. 1A, the disk **42** is covered by a rotatable fan hub **48** aerodynamically contoured to promote an airflow through the plurality of fan blades **40**. In addition, the fan section **14** includes an annular fan casing or a nacelle **50** that circumferentially surrounds the fan **38** and/or at least a portion of the core turbine engine **16**. The nacelle **50** is supported relative to the core turbine engine **16** by a plurality of circumferentially spaced outlet guide vanes **52**. Moreover, a downstream section **54** of the nacelle **50** extends over an outer portion of the core turbine engine **16** to define a bypass airflow passage **56** therebetween.

(48) During operation of the turbine engine **10**, a volume of air **58** enters the turbine engine **10** through an inlet **60** of the nacelle **50** and/or the fan section **14**. As the volume of air **58** passes across the fan blades **40**, a first portion of air **62** is directed or routed into the bypass airflow passage **56**, and a second portion of air **64** is directed or is routed into the upstream section of the core air flowpath, or, more specifically, into the annular inlet **20** of the LP compressor **22**. The ratio between the first portion of air **62** and the second portion of air **64** is commonly known as a bypass ratio. The pressure of the second portion of air **64** is then increased as it is routed through the HP compressor **24** and into the combustion section **26**, where the highly pressurized air is mixed with fuel and burned to provide combustion gases **66**, as detailed further below.

(49) The combustion gases **66** are routed into the HP turbine **28** and expanded through the HP turbine **28** where a portion of thermal and/or of kinetic energy from the combustion gases **66** is extracted via sequential stages of HP turbine stator vanes **68** that are coupled to the outer casing **18** and the HP turbine rotor blades **70** that are coupled to the HP shaft **34**, thus causing the HP shaft **34** to rotate, thereby supporting operation of the HP compressor **24**. The combustion gases **66** are then

routed into the LP turbine **30** and expanded through the LP turbine **30**. Here, a second portion of thermal and kinetic energy is extracted from the combustion gases **66** via sequential stages of the LP turbine stator vanes **72** that are coupled to the outer casing **18** and the LP turbine rotor blades **74** that are coupled to the LP shaft **36**, thus, causing the LP shaft **36** to rotate. This thereby supports operation of the LP compressor **22** and rotation of the fan **38** via the gearbox assembly **46**.

(50) The combustion gases **66** are subsequently routed through the jet exhaust nozzle section **32** of the core turbine engine **16** to provide propulsive thrust. Simultaneously, the pressure of the first portion of air **62** is substantially increased as the first portion of air **62** is routed through the bypass airflow passage **56** before being exhausted from a fan nozzle exhaust section **76** of the turbine engine **10**, also providing propulsive thrust. The HP turbine **28**, the LP turbine **30**, and the jet exhaust nozzle section **32** at least partially define a hot gas path **78** for routing the combustion gases **66** through the core turbine engine **16**.

(51) The turbine engine **10** depicted in FIG. **1A** is by way of example only. In other exemplary embodiments, the turbine engine **10** may have any other suitable configuration. For example, in other exemplary embodiments, the fan **38** may be configured in any other suitable manner (e.g., as a fixed pitch fan) and further may be supported using any other suitable fan frame configuration. Moreover, it should be appreciated that, in other exemplary embodiments, any other suitable number or configuration of compressors, turbines, shafts, or a combination thereof may be provided. In still other exemplary embodiments, aspects of the present disclosure may be incorporated into any other suitable gas turbine engine, such as, for example, turbofan engines, propfan engines, turbojet engines, and/or turboshaft engines.

(52) FIG. **1B** is a schematic partial cross-sectional view of a portion of an exemplary combustion section **26** having a deflector assembly **160** used in a turbine engine system, as may incorporate various embodiments of the present disclosure. The turbine engine system may be the turbine engine **10** of FIG. **1A**. Turbine engine systems may include any suitable configuration, such as, but not limited to, turbofan, turboprop, turboshaft, turbojet, or prop-fan configurations for aviation, marine, or power generation purposes. Still further, other suitable configurations may include steam turbine engines or another Brayton cycle machine. Various embodiments of the combustion section **26** may further define a rich burn combustor in particular. Other embodiments may, however, define a lean burn combustor configuration. In the exemplary embodiment, the combustion section **26** includes an annular combustor. One skilled in the art will appreciate that the combustor may be any other combustor, including, but not limited to, a single annular combustor or a double annular combustor, a can-combustor, or a can-annular combustor.

(53) As shown in FIG. **1B**, the combustion section **26** includes an outer liner **102** and an inner liner **104** disposed between an outer combustor casing **106** and an inner combustor casing **108**. The outer liner **102** and the inner liner **104** are spaced radially from each other such that a combustion chamber **110** is defined therebetween. The outer liner **102** and the outer combustor casing **106** form an outer passage **112** therebetween, and the inner liner **104** and the inner combustor casing **108** form an inner passage **114** therebetween.

(54) The combustion section **26** may also include a combustor assembly **118** comprising an annular dome assembly **120** mounted upstream of the combustion chamber **110**. The combustor assembly **118** is configured to be coupled to the forward ends of the outer liner **102** and the inner liner **104**. More particularly, the combustor assembly **118** includes an inner annular dome **122** attached to the forward end of the inner liner **104** and an outer annular dome **124** attached to the forward end of the outer liner **102**.

(55) The combustion section **26** may be configured to receive an annular stream of discharge air **126** (e.g., the pressurized air **64** in FIG. **1A**) from a discharge outlet of the HP compressor **24** of the turbine engine **10** (FIG. **1A**). To assist in directing the compressed air, the annular dome assembly **120** may further comprise an inner cowl **128** and an outer cowl **130** that may be coupled to the upstream ends of the inner liner **104** and the outer liner **102**, respectively. In this regard, an annular

opening **132** formed between the inner cowl **128** and the outer cowl **130** enables compressed fluid to enter combustion section **26** through a diffuse opening in a direction generally indicated by flow direction **134**. The compressed air may enter into a cavity **136** defined at least in part by the annular dome assembly **120**. In various embodiments, the cavity **136** is more specifically defined between the inner annular dome **122** and the outer annular dome **124**, and the inner cowl **128** and the outer cowl **130**. As will be discussed in more detail below, a portion of the compressed air in the cavity **136** may be used for combustion, while another portion may be used for cooling the combustion section **26**.

(56) In addition to directing air into the cavity **136** and the combustion chamber **110**, the inner cowl **128** and the outer cowl **130** may direct a portion of the compressed air around the outside of the combustion chamber **110** to facilitate cooling the outer liner **102** and the inner liner **104**. For example, as shown in FIG. **1B**, a portion of the discharge air **126** may flow around the combustion chamber **110**, as indicated by outer passage flow direction **138** and inner passage flow direction **140**, to provide cooling air to the outer passage **112** and the inner passage **114**, respectively.

(57) In certain exemplary embodiments, the inner annular dome **122** may be formed integrally as a single annular component, and, similarly, the outer annular dome **124** may also be formed integrally as a single annular component. In still certain embodiments, the inner annular dome **122** and the outer annular dome **124** may together be formed as a single integral component. In still various embodiments, the annular dome assembly **120**, including one or more of the inner annular dome **122**, the outer annular dome **124**, the outer liner **102**, or the inner liner **104**, may be formed as a single integral component. In other exemplary embodiments, the inner annular dome **122** and/or the outer annular dome **124** may alternatively be formed by one or more components joined in any suitable manner. For example, with reference to the outer annular dome **124**, in certain exemplary embodiments, the outer cowl **130** may be formed separately from the outer annular dome **124** and attached to the forward end of the outer annular dome **124** using, e.g., a welding process, a mechanical fastener, a bonding process or adhesive, or a composite layup process. Additionally, or alternatively, the inner annular dome **122** may have a similar configuration.

(58) The combustor assembly **118** further includes a plurality of mixer assemblies **142** spaced along a circumferential direction between the outer annular dome **124** and the inner annular dome **122**. In this regard, the annular dome assembly **120** defines an opening in which a swirler, a cyclone, or a mixer assembly **142** is mounted, attached, or otherwise integrated for introducing the air/fuel mixture into the combustion chamber **110**. Notably, compressed air may be directed from the combustion section **26** into or through one or more of the mixer assemblies **142** to support combustion in the upstream end of the combustion chamber **110**.

(59) A liquid fuel and/or a gaseous fuel is transported to the combustion section **26** by a fuel distribution system (not shown), where it is introduced at the front end of a burner in a highly atomized spray from a fuel nozzle. In an exemplary embodiment, each mixer assembly **142** may define an opening for receiving a fuel injector **146** (details are omitted for clarity). The fuel injector **146** may inject fuel in a longitudinal direction, as well as in a generally radial direction, where the fuel may be swirled with the incoming compressed air. Thus, each mixer assembly **142** receives compressed air from the annular opening **132** and fuel from a corresponding fuel injector **146**. Fuel and pressurized air are swirled and mixed together by the mixer assemblies **142**, and the resulting fuel/air mixture is discharged into combustion chamber **110** for combustion thereof.

(60) The combustion section **26** may further comprise an ignition assembly (e.g., one or more igniters extending through the outer liner **102**) suitable for igniting the fuel-air mixture. Details of the fuel injectors and the ignition assembly are omitted in FIG. **1B** for clarity. Upon ignition, the resulting hot combustion gases may flow in a generally axial direction through the combustion chamber **110** into and through the turbine section of the engine where a portion of thermal and/or kinetic energy from the hot combustion gases is extracted via sequential stages of turbine stator vanes and turbine rotor blades. More specifically, the hot combustion gases may flow into an

annular, first stage turbine nozzle **148**. As is generally understood, the first stage turbine nozzle **148** may be defined by an annular flow channel that includes a plurality of radially extending, circularly spaced nozzle vanes **150** that turn the gases so that they flow angularly and impinge upon the first stage turbine blades of the HP turbine **28** of the turbine engine **10** (FIG. **1A**).

(61) Referring still to FIG. **1B**, the plurality of mixer assemblies **142** are placed circumferentially within the annular dome assembly **120**. Fuel injectors **146** are disposed in each mixer assembly **142** to provide fuel and to support the combustion process. Each dome has a heat shield, for example, a deflector assembly **160** that thermally insulates the annular dome assembly **120** from the extremely high temperatures generated in the combustion chamber **110** during engine operation (e.g., from the hot combustion gases). The inner annular dome **122**, the outer annular dome **124**, and the deflector assembly **160** may define a plurality of openings **144** for receiving the mixer assemblies **142**. As shown, the plurality of openings **144** are, in one embodiment, circular. In other embodiments, the openings **144** are ovalar, elliptical, polygonal, oblong, or other non-circular cross sections. The deflector assembly **160** is mounted on a combustion chamber side (e.g., a downstream side) of the annular dome assembly **120**. The deflector assembly **160** may include a plurality of panels, also referred to as deflector panels **240**, as detailed further below.

(62) Compressed air (e.g., the discharge air **126**) flows into the annular opening **132** where a portion of the discharge air **126** will be used to mix with fuel for combustion and another portion will be used for cooling the deflector assembly **160**. Compressed air may flow around the fuel injector **146** and through swirler vanes **145** (shown in FIG. **2A**) around the circumference of the mixer assemblies **142**, where compressed air is mixed with fuel and directed into the combustion chamber **110**. Another portion of the air enters into a cavity **136** defined by the annular dome assembly **120**, the inner cowl **128**, and the outer cowl **130**. The compressed air in the cavity **136** is used, at least in part, to cool the annular dome assembly **120** and the deflector assembly **160**, as detailed further below.

(63) FIG. **2A** is a schematic enlarged cross-sectional view, taken at detail **2A** in FIG. **1B**, of the annular dome assembly **120** and the deflector assembly **160**, according to an aspect of the present disclosure. The annular dome assembly **120** and the deflector assembly **160** extend circumferentially about a central longitudinal axis of the combustion section **26**. While the exemplary embodiment described herein depicts the outer annular dome **124** of the annular dome assembly **120**, aspects of the present disclosure may, of course, also be utilized in an area of the inner annular dome **122**.

(64) The annular dome assembly **120** may include one or more panels **202**, also referred to as dome panels **202** (only one of which is shown in the figures) together to form an integral annular component. In some embodiments, each dome panel **202** may be formed separately and the one or more dome panels **202** may be configured together to form the annular dome assembly **120**. In some embodiments, the one or more dome panels **202** may be formed of a singular or unitary structure that defines the annular component of the annular dome assembly **120**. With reference to FIGS. **5B**, each dome panel **202** includes a circumferential outer side **204** and a circumferential inner side **206**. Each dome panel **202** may also include a first radially extending side **208** and a second radially extending side **210** that each extend from the circumferential outer side **204** and the circumferential inner side **206**. Each dome panel **202** includes an upstream surface **212**, also referred to as a dome upstream surface **212**, and a downstream surface **214**, also referred to as a dome downstream surface **214** opposite of the dome upstream surface **212**.

(65) As shown in FIG. **2A**, each dome panel **202** of the annular dome assembly **120** may include a first axially extending wall **216** defining a portion of a respective opening **144** and for receiving a respective mixer assembly **142**. The first axially extending wall **216** extends at an angle with respect to a central longitudinal axis of the respective mixer assembly **142**. In this way, the first axially extending wall **216** is angled to correspond to an angle of the respective mixer assembly **142** such that the respective mixer assembly **142** can be inserted into the opening **144**. Each dome

panel **202** may also include a second axially extending wall **218** at a radially outer portion of each dome panel **202**. Each dome panel **202** may extend between the first axially extending wall **216** and the second axially extending wall **218**. Each dome panel **202** may be attached to the outer cowl **130** (and/or to the inner cowl **128**) at the second axially extending wall **218** by one or more fastening mechanisms **165** to fasten the annular dome assembly **120** to the inner cowl **128** and the outer cowl **130**. Of course, other means of fastening the annular dome assembly **120** to the inner cowl **128** and the outer cowl **130** may be implemented instead.

(66) Each dome panel **202** of the annular dome assembly **120** may include one or more arms **220**, also referred to as dome arms **220**, extending between a proximal, first end **221** and a distal, second end **223**. The first end **221** may be connected to the dome upstream surface **212** of a respective dome panel **202** such that each dome arm **220** extends from the dome upstream surface **212** to the second end **223**. In this way, the one or more dome arms **220** may be disposed in the cavity **136** such that the one or more dome arms **220** are exposed to the cooling air within the cavity **136**. The one or more dome arms **220** may be formed integral with a respective dome panel **202**. In some examples, the one or more dome arms **220** may be formed separately and attached to a respective dome panel **202**, e.g., by brazing, welding, or the like. In the exemplary embodiment, the second end **223** may be a “free end” of a respective dome arm **220** such that the second end **223** is not in contact with another member. Of course, the second end **223** may be in contact with another member such that the second end **223** is not considered a “free end.”

(67) Each dome arm **220** may include an axial length $L_{sub.A1}$ (e.g., a length extending in an axial direction) defined from the first end **221** (e.g., at the dome upstream surface **212**) to the second end **223**. With reference to FIG. 6B, each dome arm **220** may also include a thickness, also called a radial length $L_{sub.R1}$ (e.g., a length extending in a radial direction), and a circumferential length $L_{sub.C1}$ (e.g., a length extending in a circumferential direction). The axial length, the radial length, and the circumferential length of each dome arm **220** may be chosen to minimize thermal stress and mechanical stress on the deflector assembly **160**, as detailed further below. Each dome arm **220** may be positioned on a respective dome panel **202** at a respective radial location and a respective circumferential location, as detailed further below.

(68) As shown in FIG. 2A, the one or more dome arms **220** may each define an aperture **222**, also referred to as a slot, for receiving a respective arm **260**, also referred to as a deflector arm **260**, of the deflector assembly **160**, as detailed further below. The aperture **222** may extend through the dome downstream surface **214** of a respective dome panel **202**. The aperture **222** of each dome arm **220** may include an axial length (e.g., a length extending in an axial direction), a diameter, also called a thickness or a radial height (e.g., a height extending in a radial direction), and a circumferential length (e.g., a length extending in a circumferential direction). The axial length of a respective aperture **222** may generally correspond to the axial length of a respective dome arm **220**. The circumferential length of a respective aperture **222** may generally correspond to the circumferential length of a respective dome arm **220**. A respective aperture **222** may include a size and/or a shape to receive a respective deflector arm **260** of the deflector assembly **160**, as detailed below. The axial length and the circumferential length of a respective aperture **222** may be less than the axial length and the circumferential length of a respective dome arm **220**, respectively. Further, the diameter of a respective aperture **222** may include any size for receiving a respective deflector arm **260** of the deflector assembly **160**. In some examples, the aperture **222** may be located radially inward or radially outward of the one or more dome arms **220**. For example, the aperture **222** may extend only through the dome upstream surface **212** and the dome downstream surface **214** of a respective dome panel **202**. In this way, a respective deflector arm **260** of the deflector assembly **160** may be positioned radially outward from a respective dome arm **220** or a respective deflector arm **260** of the deflector assembly **160** may be positioned radially inward from a respective dome arm **220**.

(69) Each dome arm **220** may include a first member **225** and a second member **227** that together

define a respective dome arm **220**. For example, the first member **225** may include a radially outer member of each dome arm **220** and the second member **227** may include a radially inner member of each dome arm **220**. Accordingly, the first member **225** may be radially spaced from the second member **227** such that the first member **225** and the second member **227** define the aperture **222**. The first member **225** and the second member **227** may extend from the dome upstream surface **212** of each dome panel **202** at approximately the same length to define the length of the respective dome arm **220**. The first member **225** and the second member **227** may also extend from the dome upstream surface **212** of each dome panel **202** at different lengths, as desired. The first member **225** and the second member **227** may include separate members such that the first member **225** and the second member **227** are not connected with each other. The first member **225** and the second member **227** may also be connected with each other, for example, at the second end **223** of a respective dome arm **220** such that the first member **225** and the second member **227** form a single, integral component of a respective dome arm **220**. While a first member **225** and a second member **227** are described herein, a respective dome arm **220** may include any number of members, as desired. For example, a respective dome arm **220** may include only a single member. In some examples, a respective dome arm **220** may include more than two members. In some examples, the first member **225** may be spaced circumferentially from the second member **227** (as shown in FIG. 7B).

(70) With continued reference to FIG. 2A, the deflector assembly **160** may include one or more panels **240**, also referred to as deflector panels **240** (only one of which is shown in the figures) together to form an integral annulus or an annular component. In some embodiments, each deflector panel **240** may be formed separately and the one or more deflector panels **240** may be configured together to form the deflector assembly **160**. In some embodiments, the one or more deflector panels **240** may be formed of a unitary structure that defines the annulus or the annular component of the deflector assembly **160**. With reference to FIGS. 5A, each deflector panel **240** includes a circumferential outer side **242** and a circumferential inner side **244**. Each deflector panel **240** may also include a first radially extending side **246** and a second radially extending side **248** that each extend from the circumferential outer side **242** and the circumferential inner side **244**. The circumferential outer side **242**, the circumferential inner side **244**, the first radially extending side **246**, and the second radially extending side **248** may together define an outer circumference of a respective deflector panel **240**. Each deflector panel **240** includes an upstream surface **250**, also referred to as a deflector upstream surface **250**, and a downstream surface **252**, also referred to as a deflector downstream surface **252** (shown in FIG. 2A), opposite of the deflector upstream surface **250**.

(71) As shown in FIG. 2A, each deflector panel **240** of the deflector assembly **160** may include an axially extending wall **254** defining a portion of a respective opening **144** and for receiving a respective mixer assembly **142**. The axially extending wall **254** extends at an angle with respect to a central longitudinal axis of the respective mixer assembly **142**. In this way, the axially extending wall **254** is angled to correspond to an angle of the respective mixer assembly **142** such that the respective mixer assembly **142** can be inserted into the opening **144**. Each deflector panel **240** may extend between the axially extending wall **254** and a radially outer end **256**. Each deflector panel **240** may include a an axially extending member **255** (as shown in FIGS. 10A to 11B) extending axially from the radially outer end **256** to seal a cavity **211** between the deflector assembly **160** and the annular dome assembly **120**, as detailed further below. When the deflector assembly **160** is mounted to the annular dome assembly **120**, the axially extending wall **254** of the deflector assembly **160** may be extend axially to a generally similar length as the first axially extending wall **216** of the annular dome assembly **120**. The axially extending wall **254** and the first axially extending wall **216** may be secured together by one or more fastening mechanisms **251** (shown schematically in FIGS. 4A to 4D). The one or more fastening mechanisms **251** may include any type of fastening mechanism, such as, for example, studs, bolts, screws, nuts, rivets, braising,

welding, or the like.

(72) Each deflector panel **240** of the deflector assembly **160** may include one or more deflector arms **260** extending between a proximal, first end **261** and a distal, second end **263**. The first end **261** may be connected to the deflector upstream surface **250** of a respective deflector panel **240** such that each deflector arm **260** extends from the deflector upstream surface **250** to the second end **263**. The one or more deflector arms **260** may be formed integral with a respective deflector panel **240**. In some examples, the one or more deflector arms **260** may be formed separately and attached to a respective deflector panel **240**, e.g., by brazing, welding, or the like. As shown in FIG. 2B, the connection between a respective deflector arm **260** and the deflector upstream surface **250** may define a corner **265**. The corner **265** may include a curved surface, also referred to as a blended joint or a blended corner, from the respective deflector arm **260** to the deflector upstream surface **250** of a respective deflector panel **240**. Such a connection between a respective deflector arm **260** and a respective deflector panel **240** may provide for reduced stress or for minimized stress between the respective deflector arm **260** and the respective deflector panel **240**.

(73) The one or more deflector arms **260** may be circumferentially located on the deflector upstream surface **250** of a respective dome panel **240** and may be radially located on the deflector upstream surface **250** of a respective deflector panel **240** such that each deflector arm **260** may align with a respective aperture **222** of the annular dome assembly **120**. Accordingly, each deflector arm **260** of the deflector assembly **160** may be inserted into the aperture **222** of a respective dome arm **220** of the annular dome assembly **120**. In this way, the deflector assembly **160** may be mounted to the annular dome assembly **120**. For example, a respective deflector panel **240** of the deflector assembly **160** may be mounted to a respective dome panel **202** of the annular dome assembly **120**.

(74) When the deflector assembly **160** is mounted to the annular dome assembly **120**, the one or more deflector arms **260** may be disposed between the first member **225** and the second member **227** of a respective dome arm **220** in the cavity **136**. In the exemplary embodiment, the second end **263** may be a “free end” of a respective deflector arm **260** such that the second end **263** is not in contact with another member. Of course, the second end **263** may be in contact with another member such that the second end **263** is not considered a “free end.”

(75) Each deflector arm **260** may include an axial length $L_{sub.A2}$ (e.g., a length extending in an axial direction) defined from the first end **261** (e.g., at the deflector upstream surface **250**) to the second end **263**. With reference to FIG. 5A, each deflector arm **260** may also include a thickness, also called a radial length $L_{sub.R2}$ (e.g., a length extending in a radial direction), and a circumferential length $L_{sub.C2}$ (e.g., a length extending in a circumferential direction). In the exemplary embodiment, the axial length of each deflector arm **260** may include a length such that the second end **263** of a respective deflector arm **260** generally aligns axially with the second end **223** of a respective dome arm **220** when the deflector assembly **160** is mounted to the annular dome assembly **120**. The axial length of each deflector arm **260** may also include a length such that each deflector arm **260** extends axially downstream beyond the dome downstream surface **214** of a respective dome panel **202** and the deflector assembly **160** is axially spaced from the annular dome assembly **120** when the deflector assembly **160** is mounted to the annular dome assembly **120**. Thus, a cavity **211**, or a gap, is formed between the deflector assembly **160** and the annular dome assembly **120**.

(76) The axial length of each deflector arm **260** and the axial length of each dome arm **220** may be chosen as a function of a diameter of the fastening mechanisms **270**. For example, the axial length of each deflector arm **260** and of each dome arm **220** may include a length of at least two times a diameter of the fastening mechanisms **270**. In this way, each deflector arm **260** and each dome arm **220** may be long enough to provide mechanical strength and withstand mechanical stresses around the fastening mechanisms **270**. The axial length of each deflector arm **260** and of each dome arm **220** may include a maximum axial length of eight times a diameter of the fastening mechanisms

270. The maximum axial length of each deflector arm **260** and of each dome arm **220** may be chosen such that the respective deflector arm **260** and the respective dome arm **220** do not interfere with airflow into the swirler vanes **145**. In this way, the maximum axial length of each deflector arm **260** and of each dome arm **220** may be up to an axial location of a downstream surface **147** of the swirler vanes **145**.

(77) The radial length of each deflector arm **260** may generally correspond to the diameter of a respective aperture **222**. The radial length of each deflector arm **260** and of each dome arm **220** may be the same thickness of the deflector panel **240** and of the dome panel **202**, respectively, at a minimum. The radial length of each deflector arm **260** and of each dome arm **220** may be two times the thickness of the deflector panel **240** and of the dome panel **202**, respectively, at a maximum. Such a range of the radial height of each deflector arm **260** and of each dome arm **220** may provide for strength and stiffness of each deflector arm **260** and of each dome arm **220** to withstand mechanical stresses on the respective deflector arm **260** and on the respective dome arm **220**. The radial length of each deflector arm **260** and of each dome arm **220** may be chosen as a function of providing strength and stiffness, while minimizing overall weight of the respective deflector panel **240** and of the respective dome panel **202**.

(78) The circumferential length of each deflector arm **260** may generally correspond to the circumferential length of a respective aperture **222**. Accordingly, a respective deflector arm **260** may be inserted into a respective aperture **222**. Further, the radial length of the respective deflector arm **260** may include a length such that a gap **259** (shown in FIGS. 3A and 3B) between an inner surface of a respective dome arm **220** of the annular dome assembly **120** and the outer surface of a respective deflector arm **260** of the deflector assembly **160** may be minimized. In this way, any leakage of air between a respective deflector arm **260** and a respective dome arm **220** may be reduced.

(79) The circumferential length of each deflector arm **260** and of each dome arm **220** be two times a diameter of the fastening mechanisms **270**, at a minimum. The circumferential length of each deflector arm **260** and of each dome arm **220** may be 360°. Such a range of the circumferential length of each deflector arm **260** and of each dome arm **220** may provide strength and stiffness for withstanding mechanical stresses on the respective deflector arm **260** and on the respective dome arm **220**. The circumferential length of each deflector arm **260** and of each dome arm **220** may be chosen as a function of providing strength and stiffness for withstanding mechanical stresses, while minimizing overall weight of the respective deflector panel **240** and of the respective dome panel **202**.

(80) The circumferential length of each deflector arm **260** and of each dome arm **220** is defined by an arc angle, also referred to as the angular extent of the deflector arm **260** and of the dome arm **220**, respectively. The minimum arc angle of each deflector arm **260** and of each dome arm **220** is defined as $180/\pi \times (2d/2 \times \pi \times R)$, where d is the diameter of the fastening mechanism **270** and R is the length of the fastening mechanism **270**. For example, when d is six millimeters, and R is thirty millimeters, the minimum arc angle of the respective deflector arm **260** and of the respective dome arm **220** for one fastening mechanism **270** is four degrees. The maximum arc angle of each deflector arm **260** and of each dome arm **220** is defined as $360/(1.5 \text{ to } 2 \times N)$, where N is the number of bolts on the respective deflector arm **260** and on the respective dome arm **220**. The arc angle when three fastening mechanisms **270** are used for the respective deflector arm **260** and for the respective dome arm **220** is sixty degrees.

(81) FIGS. 3A and 3B are front views, taken at line 3-3 in FIG. 2A, of various embodiments of a respective deflector arm **260** of the deflector assembly **160** mounted within a respective dome arm **220** of the annular dome assembly **120**. In the embodiment of FIG. 3A, the respective deflector arm **260** and the respective dome arm **220** include a generally arc shape or a generally C-shape in the circumferential direction. In the embodiment of FIG. 3B, the respective deflector arm **260** and the respective dome arm **220** include a generally cylindrical shape or a generally rod-like shape. As

discussed above, the respective deflector arm **260** may include a size and/or a shape that generally corresponds to the size and/or the shape of a respective aperture **222** of the respective dome arm **220**. It is noted that the gap **259** shown in FIGS. **3A** and **3B** is for illustrative purposes, and the gap **259** may be smaller.

(82) Referring again to FIG. **2A**, when a respective deflector arm **260** of the deflector assembly **160** is disposed within a respective aperture **222** of the annular dome assembly **120**, one or more fastening mechanisms **270** may be used to fasten the respective deflector arm **260** to the respective dome arm **220**. The one or more fastening mechanisms **270** may include any type of fastening mechanism, such as, for example, studs, bolts, screws, nuts, rivets, braising, welding, or the like. The one or more fastening mechanisms **270** may be located at an axial position of a respective deflector arm **260** and a respective dome arm **220** upstream of the dome upstream surface **212** of a respective dome panel **202** of the annular dome assembly **120**. Accordingly, the one or more fastening mechanisms **270** may be disposed entirely upstream of the dome upstream surface **212** such that the one or more fastening mechanisms **270** are disposed in cavity **136** and away from the deflector downstream surface **252** (e.g., a hot side) of a respective deflector panel **240** of the deflector assembly **160**. In this way, the one or more fastening mechanisms **270** may be located away from the hot combustion gases. Such an arrangement may provide for reduced thermal stress on the deflector assembly **160** and may provide for reduced mechanical stress on the deflector assembly **160**.

(83) In the embodiments of FIGS. **2A** and **4A**, the respective fastening mechanism **270** may include brazing, or a similar material joining process, the respective deflector arm **260** and the respective dome arm **220** together in an area around the second end **263** of the respective deflector arm **260** and the second end **223** of the respective dome arm **220**. The brazing is shown schematically in FIGS. **2A** and **4A**. In the embodiments of FIGS. **4B** to **4D**, the respective fastening mechanisms **270** may include a bolt, or the like, inserted radially into a respective hole (not shown) of the respective deflector arm **260** and the respective dome arm **220**. While a single fastening mechanism **270** is shown at a respective deflector arm **260** and a respective dome arm **220**, a plurality of fastening mechanisms **270** may be utilized for securing a respective deflector arm **260** to a respective dome arm **220**. For example, a respective deflector arm **260** and a respective dome arm **220** may include two to three, or more, fastening mechanisms **270** associated therewith. In some instances, when a bolt or similar fastening mechanism is utilized, air may leak through around the bolt, the respective deflector arm **260**, and the respective dome arm **220**. Accordingly, brazing, welding, or a similar fastening mechanism may be utilized instead of, or in combination with, the respective bolt to reduce leakage of air or eliminate leakage of air around the bolt.

(84) FIG. **2A** shows the one or more dome panels **202** of the annular dome assembly **120** may include one or more dome feed cooling holes (indicated at dome feed cooling arrows **280**) extending from the dome upstream surface **212** to the dome downstream surface **214** of a respective dome panel **202**. The one or more dome panels **202** may also include one or more corner cooling holes (indicated at corner cooling arrows **282**) extending from the dome upstream surface **212** to the dome downstream surface **214**. The one or more deflector panels **240** of the deflector assembly **160** may include one or more multi-hole cooling holes (indicated at multi-hole cooling arrows **284**) extending from the deflector upstream surface **250** to the deflector downstream surface **252** of each deflector panel **240**. The multi-hole cooling holes are indicated by multi-hole cooling arrows **284**.

(85) In operation, cooling air from cavity **136** (e.g., cold, compressed air) may cool the one or more dome arms **220**, the one or more deflector arms **260**, and/or the one or more fastening mechanisms **270**. The cooling air may flow from the cavity **136** and through the one or more dome feed cooling holes (e.g., at the dome feed cooling arrows **280**) and into the cavity **211**. As indicated by the dome feed cooling arrows **280**, the cooling air through the one or more dome feed cooling holes may impinge on the deflector upstream surface **250** of a respective deflector panel **240** of the deflector

assembly **160**. The cooling air may flow from the cavity **211** and through the one or more multi-hole cooling holes (e.g., at the multi-hole cooling arrows **284**) to provide a curtain of cooling air at the deflector downstream surface **252** of a respective deflector panel **240** of the deflector assembly **160**. As shown in FIG. 2A, the cooling air may also flow from cavity **136** and through the one or more corner cooling holes (e.g., at the corner cooling arrows **282**) and may be directed to the corner **265** of the one or more deflector arms **260** and a respective deflector panel **240** of the deflector assembly **160**. In this way, the corner **265** may be provided with additional cooling air to improve cooling at the corner **265**.

(86) The one or more dome feed cooling holes, the one or more corner cooling holes, and the one or more multi-hole cooling holes may be sized, shaped, and/or angled, as desired to provide cooling at the deflector upstream surface **250**, the deflector downstream surface **252**, and the corner **265**, respectively. Further, the one or more dome feed cooling holes may include any number of cooling holes located at any radial location and/or any circumferential location of a respective dome panel **202** to provide impingement cooling from the cavity **136** to the deflector upstream surface **250** of a respective deflector panel **240**. The one or more corner cooling holes may include any number of cooling holes located at any radial location and/or any circumferential location of a respective dome panel **202** to provide impingement cooling on a respective corner **265** of a respective deflector panel **240**. The one or more multi-hole cooling holes may include any number of cooling holes located at any radial location and/or any circumferential location of a respective deflector panel **240** to provide cooling from the cavity **136** to the deflector downstream surface **252** of a respective deflector panel **240**.

(87) FIGS. 4A to 4D illustrate cross-sectional views of various embodiments of the annular dome assembly **120** and the deflector assembly **160** isolated from the combustion section **26**. The embodiments of FIGS. 4A to 4D include many of the same or similar components and functionality as the embodiment shown in FIG. 2A. The same reference numeral is used for the same or similar components in these embodiments, and a detailed description of these components and functionality is omitted here. Some reference numerals have been removed for clarity.

(88) In the embodiments of FIGS. 4A and 4B, a respective deflector panel **240** of the deflector assembly **160** may include a split panel such that the respective deflector panel **240** includes two or more separate segments **400**. A gap **402** may be defined between each respective segment **400** of a deflector panel **240**. Each segment **400** may include one or more deflector arms **260** such that each segment **400** may be mounted to and/or removed from a respective dome panel **202** of the annular dome assembly **120** separately. For example, the deflector arms **260** of each segment **400** of a respective deflector panel **240** may be inserted into respective dome arms **220** of a respective dome panel **202** of the annular dome assembly **120**. When mounted, the segments **400** may together form a respective deflector panel **240**. Segmenting or otherwise splitting a respective deflector panel **240** in such a way may enable ease of removal and/or ease of replacement of a respective segment **400** such that individual segments **400** may be removed and/or may be replaced without the need to remove and/or to replace an entire deflector panel **240**. In this way, the segments **400** of a respective deflector panel **240** may enable ease of maintenance if one or more respective segments **400** are damaged. Cooling air may also flow through the gap **402** between respective segments **400** (as indicated by the multi-hole cooling arrows **284** in FIG. 4A FIG. 4B).

(89) In the embodiment of FIG. 4C, the one or more deflector panels **240** of the deflector assembly **160** may include one or more partition arms **460**. The one or more partition arms **460** may form a partition between respective segments **400** of a respective deflector panel **240**. The one or more partition arms **460** may include a shorter length than the deflector arms **260** of the deflector assembly **160**. For example, the partition arms **460** may extend from the deflector upstream surface **250** of the respective deflector panel **240** to the dome downstream surface **214** of the dome panel **202** of the annular dome assembly **120**. In this way, the one or more partition arms **460** may not extend through the dome panel **202**. The one or more partition arms **460** may also include one or

more cooling holes for allowing cooling air to flow therethrough (as indicated by the dome feed cooling arrow **280** in FIG. 4C). In this way, a desired amount of cooling air may be directed through the one or more partition arms **460** to various segments **400** of the respective deflector panel **240**.

(90) In the embodiment of FIG. 4D, the one or more dome panels **202** of the annular dome assembly **120** may include two or more dome arms **220**. The one or more deflector panels **240** of the deflector assembly **160** may include two or more deflector arms **260** corresponding to the two or more dome arms **220**, as detailed above with respect to FIG. 2A. The two or more dome arms **220** and the two or more deflector arms **260** may be located at different circumferential and radial locations, as detailed below. Further, each segment **400** may include a respective deflector arm **260**, as detailed above. In this way, each segment **400** may be attached to and/or removed from the respective dome panel **202**, separately.

(91) FIG. 5A is a front view of a deflector upstream surface **250** of a respective deflector panel **240** of the deflector assembly **160** and isolated from the annular dome assembly **120**. FIG. 5B is a front view of a dome upstream surface **212** of a respective dome panel **202** of the annular dome assembly **120** with a respective deflector panel **240** mounted thereon. For example, the one or more deflector arms **260** are inserted into the respective one or more dome arms **220** (e.g., in the aperture **222**) of the respective dome panel **202**. The deflector panel **240** is not visible in FIG. 5B due to the respective deflector panel **240** being mounted behind the respective dome panel **202** in such a view. The embodiments of FIGS. 5A and 5B include many of the same or similar components and functionality as the embodiment shown in FIGS. 2A and 4D. The same reference numeral is used for the same or similar components in these embodiments, and a detailed description of these components and functionality is omitted here. Some reference numerals have been removed for clarity.

(92) The deflector panel **240** may include a plurality of deflector arms **260** and the dome panel **202** may include a corresponding plurality of dome arms **220** (FIG. 5B). In the embodiment shown, the deflector panel **240** includes three such deflector arms **260** and the dome panel **202** includes three corresponding dome arms **220**. As discussed above, the deflector panel **240** and the dome panel **202** may include any number of the deflector arms **260** and the dome arms **220**, respectively. The deflector arms **260** of the deflector panel **240** may be spaced from each other at various arc angles around a radial and circumferential position on the deflector upstream surface **250** of the deflector panel **240**. For example, the deflector arms **260** may be spaced around a first circumference **501** that is radially between the opening **144** and the outer circumference of the deflector panel **240**. The dome arms **220** may be spaced around the first circumference **501** on the dome panel **202** such that the deflector arms **260** may be generally aligned with the aperture **222** of the respective dome arms **220**.

(93) The deflector arms **260** and the dome arms **220** may be located at any radial and/or any circumferential position on the deflector panel **240** and the dome panel **202**, respectively. In the embodiment of FIGS. 5A and 5B, the arc angle between each respective deflector arm **260** may be approximately thirty degrees. Such an arc angle may provide for spreading of an axial load or axial forces (shown by arrows **290**) on the deflector panel **240** and the dome panel **202** through the deflector arms **260** and the dome arms **220**, respectively, from vibrational forces, other mechanical forces, and/or forces from the cooling air. The arc angle between each respective deflector arm **260** may include any angle between thirty degrees and ninety degrees to spread the load on the deflector arms **260** and the dome arms **220**. Such a range may provide for improved durability of the deflector arms **260** and the dome arms **220**. As further shown in FIG. 5A, the cooling air (as indicated by the dome feed cooling arrows **280**) may flow through the dome feed cooling holes of the dome panel **202** and towards the deflector upstream surface **250**. The cooling air may follow a general swirl direction and may provide cooling on the deflector arms **260**.

(94) FIG. 5C is a front view of a deflector upstream surface **250** of a respective deflector panel **240**

of the deflector assembly **160** and isolated from the annular dome assembly **120**. As shown in FIG. 5C, the deflector arms **260** may be positioned on the deflector panel **240** at various locations other than circumferentially. For example, the deflector arms **260** may be generally rectilinear, and the dome panels **202** include corresponding apertures **222**. FIG. 5C also shows the deflector arms **260** may include a generally circular shape. The deflector arms **260** and the dome arms **220** may, of course, include any size, any shape, and may be arranged in any manner on the respective deflector panel **240** and on the respective dome panel **202**, as desired.

(95) FIG. 5D is a front view of a dome upstream surface **212** of a respective dome panel **202** of the annular dome assembly **120** with a respective deflector panel **240** mounted thereon. For example, the one or more deflector arms **260** are inserted into the respective one or more dome arms **220** (e.g., in the aperture **222**) of the respective dome panel **202**. The deflector panel **240** is not visible in FIG. 5D due to the respective deflector panel **240** being mounted behind the respective dome panel **202** in such a view. The embodiment of FIG. 5D includes many of the same or similar components and functionality as the embodiment shown in FIG. 2A and the embodiments shown in FIGS. 5A to 5C. The same reference numeral is used for the same or similar components in these embodiments, and a detailed description of these components and functionality is omitted here. Some reference numerals have been removed for clarity. In the embodiment of FIG. 5D, the one or more deflector arms **260** may include a generally cylindrical shape or a generally rod-like shape similar to the embodiment of FIG. 3B. The cooling air may be supplied to each deflector arm **260** around an entire circumference thereof (as indicated by the arrows **290**).

(96) FIG. 6A is a front view of a deflector upstream surface **250** of a respective deflector panel **240** of the deflector assembly **160** and isolated from the annular dome assembly **120**, according to another embodiment. FIG. 6B is a front view of a dome upstream surface **212** of a respective dome panel **202** of the annular dome assembly **120**, according to another embodiment. The embodiments of FIGS. 6A and 6B include many of the same or similar components and functionality as the embodiment shown in FIGS. 2A to 5B. The same reference numeral is used for the same or similar components in these embodiments, and a detailed description of these components and functionality is omitted here. Some reference numerals have been removed for clarity.

(97) In the embodiment of FIG. 6A, the one or more deflector arms **260** of the deflector panel **240** may be located at different radial and/or circumferential positions on the deflector panel **240**. For example, deflector panel **240** in FIG. 6A includes first deflector arms **260a** located around a first circumference **501** having a first diameter. The deflector panel **240** also includes second deflector arms **260b** located around a second circumference **503** having a second diameter that is greater than the first diameter. For clarity, only one first deflector arm **260a** and one second deflector arm **260b** is labeled in FIG. 6A. The deflector panel **240** may include deflector arms **260** at either or at both the first circumference **501** and the second circumference **503**. The deflector arms **260** may, of course, be located anywhere on the deflector upstream surface **250** of the deflector panel **240** for providing a circumferential spread of the one or more deflector arms **260** to distribute mechanical stresses, as detailed above.

(98) As shown in FIG. 6B, the dome arms **220** may be located at different radial and/or circumferential positions on the dome panel **202**. The dome arms **220** may be arranged on the dome upstream surface **212** such that the apertures **222** align with the corresponding deflector arms **260** (FIG. 6A) when the deflector panel **240** is mounted to the dome panel **202**. For example, the dome panel **202** includes first dome arms **220a** and first apertures **222a** located around the first circumference **501**. Similarly, the dome panel **202** also includes second dome arms **220b** and second apertures **222b** located around the second circumference **503**. In this way, the first deflector arms **260a** may align with, and be inserted into, the first apertures **222a**, and the second deflector arms **260b** may align with, and be inserted into, the second apertures **222b**. For clarity, only one first dome arm **220a**, one first aperture **222a**, one second dome arm **220b**, and one second aperture **222b** are labeled in FIG. 6B.

(99) FIG. 7A is a front view of a deflector upstream surface **250** of a respective deflector panel **240** of the deflector assembly **160** and isolated from the annular dome assembly **120**, according to another embodiment. FIG. 7B is a front view of a dome upstream surface **212** of a respective dome panel **202** of the annular dome assembly **120** with a respective deflector panel **240** mounted thereon, according to another embodiment. For example, the one or more deflector arms **260** of FIG. 7A are inserted into the respective one or more dome arms **220** (e.g., in the aperture **222**) of the respective dome panel **202** of FIG. 7B. The deflector panel **240** is not visible in FIG. 7B due to the respective deflector panel **240** being mounted behind the respective dome panel **202** in such a view. The embodiments of FIGS. 7A and 7B include many of the same or similar components and functionality as those in the embodiments shown in FIGS. 2A and 4D. The same reference numeral is used for the same or similar components in these embodiments, and a detailed description of these components and functionality is omitted here. Some reference numerals have been removed for clarity.

(100) As shown in FIG. 7A, the deflector panel **240** includes first deflector arms **260a** and second deflector arms **260b**. In the embodiment shown, the first deflector arms **260a** may include two such deflector arms, and the second deflector arms **260b** may include two such deflector arms. Thus, the deflector panel **240** includes four deflector arms. The first deflector arms **260a** and the second deflector arms **260b** may be spaced from each other at various arc angles around a radial and circumferential position on the deflector upstream surface **250** of the deflector panel **240**. In the embodiments of FIG. 7A, the arc angle between the first deflector arms **260a** and the second deflector arms **260b** may be approximately ninety degrees. Such an arc angle may provide for spreading of an axial load or axial forces on the deflector panel **240** through the first deflector arms **260a** and the second deflector arms **260b** from vibrational forces, other mechanical forces, and/or forces from the cooling air. As further shown in FIG. 7A, the first deflector arms **260a** and the second deflector arms **260b** are generally rectilinear. The first deflector arms **260a** are spaced radially from the opening **144** (e.g., at the mixer assembly **142**) and extend in a generally radial direction. The second deflector arms **260b** extend from the opening **144** and extend in a generally circumferential direction.

(101) As shown in FIG. 7B, the dome panel **202** includes first dome arms **220a** and second dome arms **220b**. Only one such first dome arm **220a** and one such second dome arm **220b** is labeled in FIG. 7B for clarity. In the embodiment shown, the first dome arms **220a** may include two such dome arms, and the second dome arms **220b** may include two such dome arms. Thus, the dome panel **202** includes four dome arms. Each first dome arm **220a** includes a corresponding first member **225a** and a corresponding second member **227b**. Likewise, each second dome arm **220b** includes a corresponding first member **225b** and a corresponding second member **227b**. In this way, the first dome arms **220a** define first apertures **222a** and the second dome arms **220b** define second apertures **222b**. The first dome arms **220a** and the second dome arms **220b** may be spaced from each other at various arc angles around a radial and circumferential position on the dome upstream surface **212** of the dome panel **202**. In this way, the first deflector arms **260a** align with the first apertures **222a** and the second deflector arms **260b** align with the second apertures **222b** when the deflector panel **240** is mounted to the dome panel **202** (FIG. 7B). In the embodiments of FIG. 7B, the arc angle between the first dome arms **220a** and the second dome arms **220b** may be approximately ninety degrees. Such an arc angle may provide for spreading of an axial load or axial forces on the dome panel **202** through the first dome arms **220a** and the second dome arms **220b** from vibrational forces, other mechanical forces, and/or forces from the cooling air. As further shown in FIG. 7B, the first dome arms **220a** and the second dome arms **220b** are generally rectilinear, such that the first apertures **222a** and the second apertures **222b** are generally rectilinear. In this way, a size, a shape, and a position of the first apertures **222a** and the second apertures **222b** generally correspond to a size, a shape, and a position of the first deflector arms **260a** and the second deflector arms **260b**, respectively.

(102) FIGS. **8A** to **8D** provide front views of a deflector downstream surface **252** of a respective deflector panel **240** of the deflector assembly **160** and isolated from the annular dome assembly **120**, according to various embodiments. The embodiments of FIGS. **8A** to **8D** include many of the same or similar components and functionality as the embodiment shown in FIGS. **2A** and **4D**. The embodiments of FIGS. **8A** to **8D** are substantially similar to the embodiment of FIG. **6A**. The same reference numeral is used for the same or similar components in these embodiments, and a detailed description of these components and functionality is omitted here. Some reference numerals have been removed for clarity.

(103) In the embodiment of FIG. **8A**, the deflector panel **240** may include a plurality of segments **400** separated by a plurality of gaps **402**. For example, the deflector panel **240** may include four such segments **400** separated by four respective gaps **402**. Although not illustrated in FIG. **8A**, each segment **400** may include one or more deflector arms **260** (e.g., extending from the deflector upstream surface **250**) for mounting the respective segment **400** to the annular dome assembly **120**, as detailed above. The gaps **402** may include one or more generally circular gaps and one or more generally rectilinear gaps. In this way, the deflector panel **240** may include segments **400** of various shapes and/or sizes. As shown in FIG. **8A**, the cooling air may flow through the gaps **402** and provide film cooling on the downstream surface **250** (e.g., the hot side) of the respective deflector panel **240** (as indicated by the multi-hole cooling arrows **284**). The cooling air may follow a general swirl direction (as indicated by the arrow **143**).

(104) In the embodiment of FIG. **8B**, the deflector panel **240** may include a plurality of segments **400** separated by a plurality of gaps **402**. For example, the deflector panel **240** may include seven such segments **400** separated by eight respective gaps **402**. Although not illustrated in FIG. **8B**, each segment **400** may include one or more deflector arms **260** (e.g., extending from the deflector upstream surface **250**) for mounting the respective segment **400** to the annular dome assembly **120**, as detailed above. The gaps **402** may include one or more generally circular gaps and one or more generally rectilinear gaps. In this way, the deflector panel **240** may include segments **400** of various shapes and/or various sizes.

(105) In the embodiment of FIG. **8C**, the deflector panel **240** may include a plurality of segments **400** separated by a plurality of gaps **402**. For example, the deflector panel **240** may include three such segments **400** separated by three respective gaps **402**. Although not illustrated in FIG. **8C**, each segment **400** may include one or more deflector arms **260** (e.g., extending from the deflector upstream surface **250**) for mounting the respective segment **400** to the annular dome assembly **120**, as detailed above. The gaps **402** may include one or more generally rectilinear gaps at various radial positions and/or various circumferential positions on the deflector panel **240**. For example, the gaps **402** may be positioned every one hundred twenty degrees. In this way, the deflector panel **240** may include segments **400** of various shapes and/or various sizes.

(106) In the embodiment of FIG. **8D**, the deflector panel **240** may include a plurality of segments **400** separated by a plurality of gaps **402**. For example, the deflector panel **240** may include four such segments **400** separated by four respective gaps **402**. Although not illustrated in FIG. **8D**, each segment **400** may include one or more deflector arms **260** (e.g., extending from the deflector upstream surface **250**) for mounting the respective segment **400** to the annular dome assembly **120**, as detailed above. The gaps **402** may include one or more generally rectilinear gaps at various radial positions and/or various circumferential positions on the deflector panel **240**. For example, the gaps **402** may be positioned every ninety degrees. In this way, the deflector panel **240** may include segments **400** of various shapes and/or various sizes.

(107) FIGS. **9A** to **9D** provide cross-sectional views of a respective gap **402** of a respective deflector panel **240** of the deflector assembly **160**, according to various embodiments. The embodiments of FIGS. **9A** to **9D** include many of the same or similar components and functionality as those in the embodiments shown in FIGS. **2A** to **8D**. The same reference numeral is used for the same or similar components in these embodiments, and a detailed description of these components

and functionality is omitted here. Some reference numerals have been removed for clarity.

(108) In the embodiment of FIG. 9A, the gap **402** may extend from the deflector upstream surface **250** to the deflector downstream surface **252** of the deflector panel **240**. For example, the gap **402** may extend generally axially through the deflector panel **240**. In the embodiment of FIG. 9B, the gap **402** may include a step such that respective segments **400** may overlap. In this way, an upstream portion of the gap **402** may be radially inward compared to a downstream portion of the gap **402**. In some examples, the upstream portion of the gap **402** may be radially outward from the downstream portion of the gap **402**. The step of the gap **402** may include any size, shape, and/or angle, as desired. In the embodiment of FIG. 9C, the gap **402** may be axially misaligned such that respective segments **400** overlap. For example, a first segment **400** may be positioned axially closer to the annular dome assembly **120** than a second segment **400** when the deflector panel **240** is mounted to the annular dome assembly **120**. In the embodiment of FIG. 9D, the gap **402** may include an axial angle such that the gap **402** does not extend generally axially. The axial angle may be between zero degrees and seventy-five degrees to direct the flow of cooling air to the deflector downstream surface **252**. Such a range may provide the flow cooling air from the deflector upstream surface **250** to the deflector downstream surface **252** for film cooling the deflector downstream surface **252**.

(109) FIGS. **10A** and **11A** illustrate cross-sectional views of various embodiments of the annular dome assembly **120** and the deflector assembly **160** isolated from the combustion section **26**. FIGS. **10B** and **10C** are various enlarged cross-sectional views of the annular dome assembly **120** and the deflector assembly **160**, taken at detail **10B** in FIG. **10A**, according to aspects of the present disclosure. FIG. **11B** is an enlarged cross-sectional view of the annular dome assembly **120** and the deflector assembly **160**, taken at detail **11B** in FIG. **11A**, according to aspects of the present disclosure. The embodiments of FIGS. **10A** to **11B** include many of the same or similar components and functionality as those in the embodiment shown in FIG. **2A**. The same reference numeral is used for the same or similar components in these embodiments, and a detailed description of these components and functionality is omitted here. Some reference numerals have been removed for clarity.

(110) In the embodiment of FIG. **10A**, the axially extending member **255** may extend substantially axially from the deflector upstream surface **250** of the deflector panel **240**. When the deflector panel **240** is mounted to the annular dome assembly **120**, a free end of the axially extending member **255** may be inserted into a respective groove **257** on the dome downstream surface **214** of a respective dome panel **202** of the annular dome assembly **120**. In the embodiment of FIG. **10B**, the groove **257** may be sized and/or may be shaped to generally correspond to a size and/or a shape of the axially extending member **255** such that the free end of the axially extending member **255** may fit into the groove **257** with a low amount of clearance. In the embodiment of FIG. **10C**, the groove **257** may include an angled surface such that the free end of the axially extending member **255** may sit in the groove **257** on the angled surface. The connection between the axially extending member **255** and the groove **257** may also be sealed by, for example, adhesive, welding, brazing, or the like.

(111) In the embodiment of FIG. **11A**, the axially extending member **255** may extend at an axial angle from the deflector upstream surface **250** of the deflector panel **240**. For example, the axial angle of the axially extending member **255** may be between plus or minus forty five degrees ($\pm 45^\circ$). The axial angle of the axially extending member **255** may help direct the cooling air at an angle to the outer liner **102** and/or to the inner liner **104**. Thus, the axial angle of the axially extending member **255** may help prevent hot gas ingestion and provide for improved cooling around the corners of the deflector assembly **160**. When the deflector panel **240** is mounted to the annular dome assembly **120**, a free end of the axially extending member **255** may be inserted into a respective groove **257** on the dome downstream surface **214** of a respective dome panel **202** of the annular dome assembly **120**. In the embodiment of FIG. **11B**, the groove **257** may be sized and/or

shaped to generally correspond to a size and/or a shape of the axially extending member **255** such that the free end of the axially extending member **255** may fit into the groove **257** with a low amount of clearance. The connection between the axially extending member **255** and the groove **257** may also be sealed by, for example, adhesive, welding, brazing, or the like.

(112) In some examples, the axially extending member **255** includes a seal such that the seal axially extends between the dome downstream surface **214** of the dome panel **202** and the upstream surface **252** of the dome panel **202**. In this way, the cavity **211** between the annular dome assembly **120** and the deflector assembly **160** may be sealed to control air leakage. In some examples, the axially extending member **255** may include one or more cooling holes therethrough for providing cooling air to a radially outer surface of the deflector assembly **160** and/or to other components (e.g., the outer liner **102** and/or the inner liner **104**).

(113) Further aspects of the present disclosure are provided by the subject matter of the following clauses.

(114) An annular dome assembly for a combustor, the annular dome assembly including an annular dome and a deflector assembly. The annular dome includes one or more dome panels defining the annular dome. A first dome panel of the one or more dome panels includes a dome upstream surface and a dome downstream surface, one or more dome arms, and one or more apertures. The dome downstream surface is opposite the dome upstream surface. The one or more dome arms extend from the dome upstream surface. The one or more apertures extend from the dome upstream surface to the dome downstream surface. The deflector assembly includes one or more deflector panels defining the deflector assembly. A first deflector panel of the one or more deflector panels includes a deflector upstream surface and a deflector downstream surface and one or more deflector arms. The deflector downstream surface is opposite the deflector upstream surface. The one or more deflector arms extend from the deflector upstream surface. Each of the one or more deflector arms are mounted within a respective aperture of the annular dome.

(115) The annular dome assembly of the preceding clause, the one or more dome arms defining the one or more apertures.

(116) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, the one or more dome arms and the one or more deflector arms being secured together by one or more fastening mechanisms.

(117) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, the one or more deflector arms being generally C-shaped.

(118) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, the one or more deflector arms being generally cylindrical shaped or generally rod-like shaped.

(119) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, the first dome panel including one or more corner cooling holes for directing a flow of cooling air onto a corner formed between the one or more deflector arms and the deflector upstream surface of the first deflector panel.

(120) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, a connection of the one or more deflector arms with the deflector upstream surface including a blended corner.

(121) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, the first deflector panel further including an axially extending member at a radially outer end. The axially extending member is mounted within a respective groove on the dome downstream surface of the first dome panel.

(122) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, the axially extending member including a seal.

(123) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, the one or more deflector arms including a plurality of deflector arms. Each of the plurality of deflector arms are spaced circumferentially around the deflector upstream surface of the first deflector panel.

(124) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, the plurality of deflector arms being circumferentially spaced apart from each other at an arc angle between thirty degrees and ninety degrees.

(125) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, the first deflector panel each including

a plurality of segments.

(126) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, each of the plurality of segments including one or more of the one or more deflector arms.

(127) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, a flow of cooling air being directed through one or more gaps formed between each of the plurality of segments.

(128) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, further including one or more gaps formed between each of the plurality of segments, the one or more gaps being shaped to provide a flow of cooling air to the deflector downstream surface of each of the first deflector panel.

(129) An annular dome assembly for a combustor, the annular dome assembly including an annular dome, a deflector assembly, and a one or more fastening mechanisms. The annular dome includes one or more dome panels defining the annular dome. A first dome panel of the one or more dome panels including a dome upstream surface and a dome downstream surface, one or more dome arms, and one or more apertures. The downstream surface is opposite the dome upstream surface. The one or more dome arms extend from the dome upstream surface. The one or more apertures defined by the one or more dome arms and extending from the dome upstream surface to the dome downstream surface. The deflector assembly includes one or more deflector panels defining the deflector assembly. A first deflector panel of the one or more deflector panels including a deflector upstream surface and a deflector downstream surface, one or more deflector arms, and a plurality of segments. The deflector downstream surface is opposite the deflector upstream surface. The one or more deflector arms extend from the deflector upstream surface. Each of the one or more deflector arms mounted within a respective aperture of the annular dome. The plurality of segments are separated by one or more gaps, where each of the plurality of segments include one or more of the one or more deflector arms. The one or more fastening mechanisms fasten the one or more dome arms and the one or more deflector arms together.

(130) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, the first dome panel including one or more corner cooling holes for directing a flow of cooling air onto a corner formed between the one or more deflector arms and the deflector upstream surface of the first deflector panel.

(131) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, the one or more deflector arms including a plurality of deflector arms. Each of the plurality of deflector arms are spaced circumferentially around the deflector upstream surface of the first deflector panel.

(132) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, the first deflector panel further including an axially extending member at a radially outer end. The axially extending member is mounted within a respective groove on the dome downstream surface of the first dome panel.

(133) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, the axially extending member including a seal.

(134) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, the one or more deflector arms being generally C-shaped.

(135) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, the one or more deflector arms being generally cylindrical shaped or generally rod-like shaped.

(136) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, a connection of the one or more deflector arms with the deflector upstream surface including a blended corner.

(137) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, a flow of cooling air being directed through one or more gaps.

(138) The annular dome assembly of the preceding clause, the one or more gaps being shaped to provide a flow of cooling air to the deflector downstream surface of each of the first deflector panel.

(139) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, the first dome panel further including an axially extending wall that defines a portion of an opening of the first dome panel.

(140) The annular dome assembly of the preceding clause, the axially extending wall being angled to correspond to an angle of a mixer assembly such that the mixer assembly is inserted into the

opening.

(141) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, each of the one or more dome arms including a first member and a second member that together define a respective dome arm of the one or more dome arms.

(142) The annular dome assembly of the preceding clause, the first member being radially spaced from the second member such that the first member and the second member define a respective aperture of the one or more apertures.

(143) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, the first deflector panel further including an axially extending wall that defines a portion of an opening of the first deflector panel.

(144) The annular dome assembly of the preceding clause, the axially extending wall being angled to correspond to an angle of a mixer assembly such that the mixer assembly is inserted into the opening.

(145) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, an axial length of each of the one or more deflector arms is a function of a diameter of a fastening mechanism that secures the one or more dome arms and the one or more deflector arms together.

(146) The annular dome assembly of the preceding clause, the axial length of each of the one or more deflector arms being at least two times the diameter of the fastening mechanism.

(147) The annular dome assembly of the preceding clause, the axial length of each of the one or more deflector arms being less than eight times the diameter of the fastening mechanism.

(148) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, a radial length of each of the one or more deflector arms generally corresponding to a diameter of each of the one or more apertures.

(149) The annular dome assembly of the preceding clause, a minimum radial length of each of the one or more deflector arms being a same thickness of the first deflector panel.

(150) The annular dome assembly of the preceding clause, a maximum radial length of each of the one or more deflector arms being two times the thickness of the first deflector panel.

(151) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, a circumferential length of each of the one or more deflector arms generally corresponding to a circumferential length of each of the one or more dome arms.

(152) The annular dome assembly of the preceding clause, a minimum circumferential length of each of the one or more deflector arms being two times a diameter of a fastening mechanism that secures the one or more dome arms and the one or more deflector arms together.

(153) The annular dome assembly of the preceding clause, a maximum circumferential length of each of the one or more deflector arms being three hundred sixty degrees.

(154) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, a circumferential length of each of the one or more deflector arms being defined by an arc angle.

(155) The annular dome assembly of the preceding clause, a minimum arc angle of each of the one or more deflector arms being defined as $180/\pi \times (2d/2 \times \pi \times R)$, where d is the diameter of a fastening mechanism and R is the length of the fastening mechanism.

(156) The annular dome assembly of the preceding clause, a maximum arc angle of each of the one or more deflector arms being defined as $360/(1.5 \text{ to } 2 \times N)$, where N is the number of fastening mechanisms on a respective deflector arm of the one or more deflector arms.

(157) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, the one or more fastening mechanisms being disposed entirely upstream of the dome upstream surface.

(158) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, the one or more fastening mechanisms including brazing.

(159) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, the one or more fastening mechanisms including rivets.

(160) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, the one or more fastening mechanisms including bolts.

(161) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, the first dome panel including one or

more dome feed cooling holes extending from the dome upstream surface to the dome downstream surface.

(162) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, the first deflector panels including one or more multi-hole cooling holes extending from the deflector upstream surface to the deflector downstream surface.

(163) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, the first deflector panel including one or more partition arms that form a partition between respective segments of the first deflector panel.

(164) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, the one or more partition arms axially extending from the deflector upstream surface of the first deflector panel to the dome upstream surface of the first dome panel.

(165) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, the one or more partition arms including one or more cooling holes.

(166) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, the one or more deflector arms including a first set of deflector arms being circumferentially spaced around a first circumference on the first deflector panel, the first circumference having a first diameter.

(167) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, the one or more deflector arms including a second set of deflector arms being circumferentially spaced around a second circumference on the first deflector panel, the second circumference having a second diameter, the second diameter being greater than the first diameter.

(168) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, the one or more deflector arms including a plurality of deflector arms being spaced circumferentially around the deflector upstream surface of the first deflector panel at an arc angle of thirty degrees.

(169) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, the one or more deflector arms including a plurality of deflector arms being spaced circumferentially around the deflector upstream surface of the first deflector panel at an arc angle of ninety degrees.

(170) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, the first deflector panel including a plurality of segments separated by a plurality of gaps, the plurality of gaps being generally circular.

(171) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, the first deflector panel including a plurality of segments separated by a plurality of gaps, the plurality of gaps being generally rectilinear.

(172) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, the first deflector panel including a plurality of segments separated by a plurality of gaps, the plurality of segments including three segments.

(173) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, the first deflector panel including a plurality of segments separated by a plurality of gaps, the plurality of segments including four segments.

(174) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, the first deflector panel including a plurality of segments separated by a plurality of gaps, the plurality of segments including seven segments.

(175) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, the first deflector panel including a plurality of segments separated by a plurality of gaps, the plurality of gaps being positioned every one hundred and twenty degrees around the first deflector panel.

(176) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, the first deflector panel including a plurality of segments separated by a plurality of gaps, the plurality of gaps being positioned every ninety degrees around each of the first deflector panel.

(177) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, the first deflector panel including a plurality of segments separated by a plurality of gaps, the plurality of gaps extending generally axially through each of the first deflector panel.

(178) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, the first deflector panel each including

a plurality of segments separated by a plurality of gaps, the plurality of gaps including a step such that respective segments of the plurality of segments overlap.

(179) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, the first deflector panel including a plurality of segments separated by a plurality of gaps, the plurality of gaps being misaligned such that respective segments of the plurality of segments overlap.

(180) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, the first deflector panel including a plurality of segments separated by a plurality of gaps, the plurality of gaps extending at an axial angle between zero degrees and seventy-five degrees.

(181) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, the first deflector panel further including an axially extending member at a radially outer end. The axially extending member is mounted within a respective groove on the dome downstream surface of the first dome panel, the groove including an angled surface.

(182) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, the axially extending member being mounted within a respective groove on the dome downstream surface of the first dome panel, the axially extending member being sized and shaped to generally correspond to a size and a shape of the groove.

(183) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, the axially extending member extending at an axial angle from the deflector upstream surface, the axial angle being between plus or minus forty-five degrees.

(184) The annular dome assembly of any preceding clause, axially extending wall being mounted within a respective groove on the dome downstream surface of the first dome panel, a connection between the axially extending wall and the groove being sealed.

(185) A turbine engine including a combustion section. The combustion section includes an annular dome assembly. The annular dome assembly includes an annular dome and a deflector assembly. The annular dome includes one or more dome panels defining the annular dome. A first dome panel of the one or more dome panels includes a dome upstream surface and a dome downstream surface, one or more dome arms, and one or more apertures. The dome downstream surface is opposite the dome upstream surface. The one or more dome arms extend from the dome upstream surface. The one or more apertures extend from the dome upstream surface to the dome downstream surface. The deflector assembly includes one or more deflector panels defining the deflector assembly. A first deflector panel of the one or more deflector panels includes a deflector upstream surface and a deflector downstream surface and one or more deflector arms. The deflector downstream surface is opposite the deflector upstream surface. The one or more deflector arms extend from the deflector upstream surface. Each of the one or more deflector arms are mounted within a respective aperture of the annular dome.

(186) The turbine engine of the preceding clause, the one or more dome arms defining the one or more apertures.

(187) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, the one or more dome arms and the one or more deflector arms being secured together by one or more fastening mechanisms.

(188) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, the one or more deflector arms being generally C-shaped.

(189) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, the one or more deflector arms being generally cylindrical shaped or generally rod-like shaped.

(190) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, the first dome panel including one or more corner cooling holes for directing a flow of cooling air onto a corner formed between the one or more deflector arms and the deflector upstream surface of the first deflector panel.

(191) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, a connection of the one or more deflector arms with the deflector upstream surface including a blended corner.

(192) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, the first deflector panel further including an axially extending member at a radially outer end. The axially extending member is mounted within

a respective groove on the dome downstream surface of the first dome panel.

(193) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, the axially extending member including a seal.

(194) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, the one or more deflector arms including a plurality of deflector arms. Each of the plurality of deflector arms are spaced circumferentially around the deflector upstream surface of the first deflector panel.

(195) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, the plurality of deflector arms being circumferentially spaced apart from each other at an arc angle between thirty degrees and ninety degrees.

(196) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, the first deflector panel each including a plurality of segments.

(197) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, each of the plurality of segments including one or more of the one or more deflector arms.

(198) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, a flow of cooling air being directed through one or more gaps formed between each of the plurality of segments.

(199) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, further including one or more gaps formed between each of the plurality of segments, the one or more gaps being shaped to provide a flow of cooling air to the deflector downstream surface of each of the first deflector panel.

(200) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, the first dome panel further including an axially extending wall that defines a portion of an opening of the first dome panel.

(201) The turbine engine of the preceding clause, the axially extending wall being angled to correspond to an angle of a mixer assembly such that the mixer assembly is inserted into the opening.

(202) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, each of the one or more dome arms including a first member and a second member that together define a respective dome arm of the one or more dome arms.

(203) The turbine engine of the preceding clause, the first member being radially spaced from the second member such that the first member and the second member define a respective aperture of the one or more apertures.

(204) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, the first deflector panel further including an axially extending wall that defines a portion of an opening of the first deflector panel.

(205) The turbine engine of the preceding clause, the axially extending wall being angled to correspond to an angle of a mixer assembly such that the mixer assembly is inserted into the opening.

(206) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, an axial length of each of the one or more deflector arms is a function of a diameter of a fastening mechanism that secures the one or more dome arms and the one or more deflector arms together.

(207) The turbine engine of the preceding clause, the axial length of each of the one or more deflector arms being at least two times the diameter of the fastening mechanism.

(208) The turbine engine of the preceding clause, the axial length of each of the one or more deflector arms being less than eight times the diameter of the fastening mechanism.

(209) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, a radial length of each of the one or more deflector arms generally corresponding to a diameter of each of the one or more apertures.

(210) The turbine engine of the preceding clause, a minimum radial length of each of the one or more deflector arms being a same thickness of the first deflector panel.

(211) The turbine engine of the preceding clause, a maximum radial length of each of the one or more deflector arms being two times the thickness of the first deflector panel.

(212) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, a circumferential length of each of the one or more deflector arms generally corresponding to a circumferential length of each of the one or more dome arms.

(213) The turbine engine of the preceding clause, a minimum circumferential length of each of the

one or more deflector arms being two times a diameter of a fastening mechanism that secures the one or more dome arms and the one or more deflector arms together.

(214) The turbine engine of the preceding clause, a maximum circumferential length of each of the one or more deflector arms being three hundred sixty degrees.

(215) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, a circumferential length of each of the one or more deflector arms being defined by an arc angle.

(216) The turbine engine of the preceding clause, a minimum arc angle of each of the one or more deflector arms being defined as $180/\pi \times (2d/2 \times \pi \times R)$, where d is the diameter of a fastening mechanism and R is the length of the fastening mechanism.

(217) The turbine engine of the preceding clause, a maximum arc angle of each of the one or more deflector arms being defined as $360/(1.5 \text{ to } 2 \times N)$, where N is the number of fastening mechanisms on a respective deflector arm of the one or more deflector arms.

(218) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, the one or more fastening mechanisms being disposed entirely upstream of the dome upstream surface.

(219) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, the one or more fastening mechanisms including brazing.

(220) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, the one or more fastening mechanisms including rivets.

(221) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, the one or more fastening mechanisms including bolts.

(222) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, the first dome panel including one or more dome feed cooling holes extending from the dome upstream surface to the dome downstream surface.

(223) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, the first deflector panels including one or more multi-hole cooling holes extending from the deflector upstream surface to the deflector downstream surface.

(224) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, the first deflector panel including one or more partition arms that form a partition between respective segments of the first deflector panel.

(225) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, the one or more partition arms axially extending from the deflector upstream surface of the first deflector panel to the dome upstream surface of the first dome panel.

(226) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, the one or more partition arms including one or more cooling holes.

(227) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, the one or more deflector arms including a first set of deflector arms being circumferentially spaced around a first circumference on the first deflector panel, the first circumference having a first diameter.

(228) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, the one or more deflector arms including a second set of deflector arms being circumferentially spaced around a second circumference on the first deflector panel, the second circumference having a second diameter, the second diameter being greater than the first diameter.

(229) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, the one or more deflector arms including a plurality of deflector arms being spaced circumferentially around the deflector upstream surface of the first deflector panel at an arc angle of thirty degrees.

(230) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, the one or more deflector arms including a plurality of deflector arms being spaced circumferentially around the deflector upstream surface of the first deflector panel at an arc angle of ninety degrees.

(231) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, the first deflector panel including a plurality of segments separated by a plurality of gaps, the plurality of gaps being generally circular.

(232) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, the first deflector panel including a plurality of segments separated by a plurality of gaps, the plurality of gaps being generally rectilinear.

(233) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, the first deflector panel including a plurality of

segments separated by a plurality of gaps, the plurality of segments including three segments.

(234) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, the first deflector panel including a plurality of segments separated by a plurality of gaps, the plurality of segments including four segments.

(235) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, the first deflector panel including a plurality of segments separated by a plurality of gaps, the plurality of segments including seven segments.

(236) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, the first deflector panel including a plurality of segments separated by a plurality of gaps, the plurality of gaps being positioned every one hundred and twenty degrees around the first deflector panel.

(237) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, the first deflector panel including a plurality of segments separated by a plurality of gaps, the plurality of gaps being positioned every ninety degrees around each of the first deflector panel.

(238) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, the first deflector panel including a plurality of segments separated by a plurality of gaps, the plurality of gaps extending generally axially through each of the first deflector panel.

(239) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, the first deflector panel each including a plurality of segments separated by a plurality of gaps, the plurality of gaps including a step such that respective segments of the plurality of segments overlap.

(240) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, the first deflector panel including a plurality of segments separated by a plurality of gaps, the plurality of gaps being misaligned such that respective segments of the plurality of segments overlap.

(241) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, the first deflector panel including a plurality of segments separated by a plurality of gaps, the plurality of gaps extending at an axial angle between zero degrees and seventy-five degrees.

(242) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, the first deflector panel further including an axially extending member at a radially outer end. The axially extending member is mounted within a respective groove on the dome downstream surface of the first dome panel, the groove including an angled surface.

(243) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, the axially extending member being mounted within a respective groove on the dome downstream surface of the first dome panel, the axially extending member being sized and shaped to generally correspond to a size and a shape of the groove.

(244) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, the axially extending member extending at an axial angle from the deflector upstream surface, the axial angle being between plus or minus forty-five degrees.

(245) The turbine engine of any preceding clause, axially extending wall being mounted within a respective groove on the dome downstream surface of the first dome panel, a connection between the axially extending wall and the groove being sealed.

(246) Although the foregoing description is directed to the preferred embodiments, other variations and modifications will be apparent to those skilled in the art and may be made without departing from the spirit or the scope of the disclosure. Moreover, features described in connection with one embodiment may be used in conjunction with other embodiments, even if not explicitly stated above.

Claims

1. An annular dome assembly for a combustor, the annular dome assembly comprising: an annular dome including one or more dome panels defining the annular dome, a first dome panel of the one or more dome panels including: a dome upstream surface and a dome downstream surface opposite the dome upstream surface; an opening for receiving a mixer assembly; a plurality of dome arms extending from the dome upstream surface; and a plurality of apertures extending through the first

dome panel from the dome upstream surface to the dome downstream surface, wherein the plurality of dome arms define the plurality of apertures; and a deflector assembly including one or more deflector panels defining the deflector assembly, a first deflector panel of the one or more deflector panels including: a deflector upstream surface and a deflector downstream surface opposite the deflector upstream surface; and a plurality of deflector arms extending from the deflector upstream surface, each of the plurality of deflector arms mounted within a respective aperture of the first dome panel and extending upstream of the dome upstream surface, wherein the plurality of deflector arms is spaced around a first circumference that is defined about the opening of the first dome panel, has a first diameter, and is radially between the opening and an outer circumference of the first deflector panel, each of the plurality of deflector arms being positioned at the first diameter.

2. The annular dome assembly of claim 1, wherein the plurality of deflector arms is a first plurality of deflector arms, the first deflector panel further including a second plurality of deflector arms spaced around a second circumference that is defined about the opening of the first dome panel, has a second diameter, and is radially between the opening and the outer circumference of the first deflector panel, each of the plurality of deflector arms being positioned at the second diameter.

3. The annular dome assembly of claim 2, wherein the second diameter is greater than the first diameter.

4. The annular dome assembly of claim 1, wherein the plurality of dome arms and the plurality of deflector arms are secured together by one or more fastening mechanisms disposed entirely upstream of dome upstream surface.

5. The annular dome assembly of claim 4, wherein the one or more fastening mechanisms include at least one of brazing or welding.

6. The annular dome assembly of claim 4, wherein the one or more fastening mechanisms include at least one of studs, bolts, screws, or rivets.

7. The annular dome assembly of claim 6, wherein the at least one of the studs, the bolts, the screws, or the rivets are inserted radially through the plurality of dome arms and the plurality of deflector arms.

8. The annular dome assembly of claim 1, wherein the first deflector panel includes a plurality of segments.

9. The annular dome assembly of claim 8, wherein each of the plurality of segments includes one or more of the plurality of deflector arms.

10. The annular dome assembly of claim 8, wherein the plurality of segments are separated by one or more gaps formed between each of the plurality of segments, wherein the one or more gaps are shaped to provide a flow of cooling air to the deflector downstream surface of the first deflector panel.

11. A turbine engine comprising: a combustion section including an annular dome assembly and a plurality of mixer assemblies, the annular dome assembly comprising: an annular dome including one or more dome panels defining the annular dome, a first dome panel of the one or more dome panels including: a dome upstream surface and a dome downstream surface opposite the dome upstream surface; an opening for receiving a mixer assembly; a plurality of dome arms extending from the dome upstream surface; and a plurality of apertures extending through the first dome panel from the dome upstream surface to the dome downstream surface, wherein the plurality of dome arms define the plurality of apertures; and a deflector assembly including one or more deflector panels defining the deflector assembly, a first deflector panel of the one or more deflector panels including: a deflector upstream surface and a deflector downstream surface opposite the deflector upstream surface; and a plurality of deflector arms extending from the deflector upstream surface, each of the plurality of deflector arms mounted within a respective aperture of the first dome panel and extending upstream of the dome upstream surface, wherein the plurality of deflector arms is spaced around a first circumference that is defined about the opening of the first

dome panel, has a first diameter, and is radially between the opening and an outer circumference of the first deflector panel, each of the plurality of deflector arms being positioned at the first diameter.

12. The turbine engine of claim 11, wherein the plurality of deflector arms is a first plurality of deflector arms, the first deflector panel further including a second plurality of deflector arms spaced around a second circumference that is defined about the opening of the first dome panel, has a second diameter, and is radially between the opening and the outer circumference of the first deflector panel, each of the plurality of deflector arms being positioned at the second diameter.

13. The turbine engine of claim 12, wherein the second diameter is greater than the first diameter.

14. The turbine engine of claim 11, wherein the plurality of dome arms and the plurality of deflector arms are secured together by one or more fastening mechanisms disposed entirely upstream of dome upstream surface.

15. The turbine engine of claim 14, wherein the one or more fastening mechanisms include at least one of brazing or welding.

16. The turbine engine of claim 14, wherein the one or more fastening mechanisms include at least one of studs, bolts, screws, or rivets.

17. The turbine engine of claim 16, wherein the at least one of the studs, the bolts, the screws, or the rivets are inserted radially through the plurality of dome arms and the plurality of deflector arms.

18. The turbine engine of claim 11, wherein the first deflector panel includes a plurality of segments.

19. The turbine engine of claim 18, wherein each of the plurality of segments includes one or more of the plurality of deflector arms.

20. The turbine engine of claim 18, wherein the plurality of segments are separated by one or more gaps formed between each of the plurality of segments, wherein the one or more gaps are shaped to provide a flow of cooling air to the deflector downstream surface of the first deflector panel.
